

Agreement is common in the broad sample.

Selected account histories tell a different, more contextual story.

3 agreeing replies for every 1 disagreeing reply in the broad discussion cohort: 36 agreement versus 12 disagreement. That is **75% versus 25% of 48 clearly classified cases**, not 75% of every reply.

Broad cohort: all 233 replies



Agree 36 | Disagree 12 | Mixed 9 | Neither 138 | Unclear 38

What the expanded collection adds

Cohort	Observed units	Main result
Broad discussions	233 replies / 217 accounts / 14 discussions	36 A : 12 D = 3:1
Selected account histories	120 replies / 6 accounts / 20 each	12 A : 52 D = 3:13
Authored root posts	26 posts / same 6 accounts	7 praise-only : 7 criticism-only = 1:1

Five of six selected accounts had more disagreement than agreement among their pure stance replies. Two had no agreeing reply in their 20-item windows. Neither result establishes that an account always disagrees.

Critical replies do not imply uniformly critical original posts. Account replies contained 14 praise-only and 64 criticism-only messages; authored posts contained seven of each. Both comparisons exclude mixed and non-evaluative messages from their binary ratios.

The scope of the answer

The main cohorts contain **349 unique replies** after removing four overlaps, plus 26 authored posts. This phase contributes 116 additional unique replies beyond the broad cohort. The earlier nine exploratory account follow-ups remain separate.

This is a convenience sample from visible Threads pages, including a personalized feed and deliberately selected accounts. It supports descriptions of these observations, **not a Threads-wide rate, a trend over time, or a personality label**. All collection was read-only.

Keep the denominator visible.

Only 48 of 233 replies entered the pure agreement/disagreement ratio.

Classification	Replies	Share of all 233
Agreement	36	15.5%
Disagreement	12	5.2%
Mixed	9	3.9%
Neither	138	59.2%
Unclear	38	16.3%

The 185 replies outside A+D include answers to open questions, reactions without a clear position, mixed views, and cases whose context or media could not establish a stance. Rounding may make percentages sum to 100.1%.

Variation within the sampled discussions

Discussion	All replies	A	D	A / (A+D)
Public affairs	7	5	1	83.3%
Sports	29	1	3	25.0%
Politics	31	9	1	90.0%
Public transport and manners	44	17	6	73.9%
Film interpretation	31	2	1	66.7%
Productivity app	28	1	0	100.0%
Creative quality	2	1	0	100.0%
Other seven discussions	61	0	0	Not defined

Three descriptive sensitivity checks

Largest stance discussion removed: transport/manners contributes 23 of the 48 binary cases. Excluding it leaves 19 A / 6 D, or **76% agreement**.

Presentation criticism excluded: five D labels concern posting conduct, a spoiler or caption framing. Excluding those cases leaves 36 A / 7 D, or **83.7% agreement**. This is not a complete recoding against one factual proposition.

Mixed replies split evenly: allocating half of each mixed reply to each side gives 40.5 / 57, or **71.1% agreement**. This is a convention, not a factual resolution of ambiguity. None of these checks remedies sampling bias.

A seed reply is a poor shortcut.

Twenty displayed replies per account; six accounts chosen from three agreeing and three disagreeing seeds.

Account / seed	A	D	M	N	U	Agree / A+D
Account 01 Agreeing seed	0	14	0	3	3	0/14 = 0.0%
Account 02 Agreeing seed	5	4	0	8	3	5/9 = 55.6%
Account 03 Agreeing seed	3	9	3	3	2	3/12 = 25.0%
Account 04 Disagreeing seed	0	9	0	9	2	0/9 = 0.0%
Account 05 Disagreeing seed	1	8	2	6	3	1/9 = 11.1%
Account 06 Disagreeing seed	3	8	0	5	4	3/11 = 27.3%

A agreement; D disagreement; M mixed; N neither; U unclear. Ratios describe this window only. No account meets an evidence standard for a lifetime "only agrees" or "only disagrees" claim.

What looks like a pattern

Account 01: selected from an agreeing sports reply, yet the follow-up has 14 D and no A. Fourteen of the 20 sampled messages concern the basketball-duo topic. The original seed itself shows that agreement does occur.

Account 03: 3 A, 9 D and 3 mixed; 15/20 replies concern AI and art. The observed disagreement is concentrated in a recurring topic rather than a demonstrated general disposition.

Account 02: a more varied set of topics gives 5 A versus 4 D, with 11 replies outside the binary denominator. There is little separation between the two sides in this window.

Account 04: no A and 9 D, but 9 neither and 2 unclear. The binary ratio is 100% disagreement; the share of *all* replies that disagree is only 45%.

Account 05: five replies involve one interlocutor in a personal sports dispute. Several hostile retorts are coded neither because an insult alone is not a rebuttal. **Account 06** shows both agreement and disagreement across public-affairs exchanges.

Topic labels are qualitative notes, not a standardized topic taxonomy or verified count of independent conversations. Account, topic, interlocutor and time-window effects cannot be separated here.

Stance and evaluation are different.

A reply can agree while criticizing a third party, or disagree by praising the thing being attacked.

Selected account replies: n = 120



Praise 14 | Criticism 64 | Both 13 | Neither 25 | Unclear 4

Authored root posts: n = 26



Praise 7 | Criticism 7 | Both 3 | Neither 6 | Unclear 3

Replies: 14 praise-only / 64 criticism-only = **17.9% / 82.1%** among 78 cases. **Authored posts:** 7 / 7 = **50% / 50%** among 14 cases. The authored-post comparison is particularly small and purposive.

Account	Reply P / C / B / N / U	Root posts P / C / B / N / U
Account 01	2 / 10 / 4 / 2 / 2	1 / 2 / 1 / 1 / 0
Account 02	5 / 6 / 2 / 7 / 0	3 / 0 / 0 / 2 / 0
Account 03	2 / 8 / 1 / 9 / 0	0 / 1 / 1 / 3 / 0
Account 04	0 / 15 / 1 / 2 / 2	0 / 3 / 1 / 0 / 1
Account 05	4 / 14 / 2 / 0 / 0	1 / 0 / 0 / 0 / 0
Account 06	1 / 11 / 3 / 5 / 0	2 / 1 / 0 / 0 / 2

P praise-only; C criticism-only; B both; N neither; U unclear. Root sample: five posts each except Account 05, where only one eligible authored post was displayed. Quote-post wrappers are included; third-party quoted content and self-reply continuations are excluded.

Crossovers in the 120 replies

Six disagreements are praise-only. Examples include defending a player or food quality against a negative assessment. **Four agreements are criticism-only**, and two further agreements combine praise with criticism. An agreement-only message can also contain no explicit evaluative language.

Evaluation covers explicit approval, disapproval, compliments and unfavorable judgments, including judgments of behavior. It does not equate sadness with criticism, courtesy with praise, or hostility with disagreement. The coded target can be the writer, interlocutor, an object, an idea or a third party.

Observe behavior; avoid overclaiming.

Anonymous account labels preserve comparisons without displaying account identities.

Dimension	Operational categories
Stance	A supports a position; D challenges a claim, evaluation, recommendation or framing; M does both; N has no identifiable stance; U cannot be determined.
Evaluation	P favorable appraisal only; C unfavorable appraisal only; B both; N neither; U unclear. Bare thanks or factual correction alone is not automatically praise or criticism.

How the samples were assembled

Broad: the preserved 18 September pilot and signed-in expansion use visible discussion pages discovered through the personalized feed and recommendations. Top ordering was unchanged. Collapsed branches were not systematically opened; authors, quoted embeds and an explicitly labeled AI reply were excluded.

Account replies: first 20 distinct eligible displayed replies per selected account. Three windows were collected on 18 September, three on 19 September after an interruption. One exchange involving the signed-in user was skipped and replaced. Additional records beyond the fixed windows were excluded.

Authored posts: up to five root posts per selected account in displayed order on 19 September, including pinned items. Only visible authored root text was evaluated; later self-reply parts and unexamined embedded media were not silently treated as fully read posts. Posting dates span unequal periods.

What limits the conclusions

Different targets: broad-cohort stance is relative to the original/root post. Account-cohort stance is relative to the context shown alongside the reply. Immediate parents were not systematically verified; an ancestor or quote may be the displayed context. The two ratios are not directly comparable population estimates.

Selection and dependence: personalized visibility, Top sorting, selected accounts and repeated arguments bias the sample. Replies are not independent draws. No population confidence interval or causal attribution is claimed.

Annotation uncertainty: one AI assessor, no independent annotation agreement, incomplete media interpretation and no independent bilingual review. Ambiguous sarcasm and missing parents remain unclear. Source allegations were not fact-checked or adopted as findings.

A stronger follow-up: define a common observation period, select accounts independently of stance, verify parents, sample unrelated conversations, and have a second assessor code a subset. Replicate across topics and time before calling any tendency stable.

Disagreement can draw engagement.

The evidence is strongest for emotionally charged conflict. Effects depend on the behavior being measured.

These four studies provide external context for our observations. They are a focused research selection, not a systematic review or meta-analysis. Their samples and outcomes are **not pooled with the Threads data**.

1. Opposing views can motivate confrontation

Mochon and Schwartz (2024) combined Twitter observations, Facebook field studies and controlled online experiments. They found circumstances in which content opposing a person's beliefs elicited more engagement than congenial content. Outrage helped explain this *confrontation effect*; topic importance, threat framing and the available response type mattered. [1]

Evidence boundary: experimental support for a conditional effect, not a universal rule that disagreement increases likes, comments, shares and following alike.

2. Political opposition predicts sharing

Rathje, Van Bavel and van der Linden (2021) analyzed **2,730,215 Facebook and Twitter posts** from news organizations and US congressional members. Posts about the opposing political group were shared or retweeted about **twice as often** as posts about the writer's own political group. [2]

Evidence boundary: observational association involving political group language. It does not isolate ordinary disagreement or prove that opposition caused additional sharing.

3. Feedback can reinforce outrage expression

Brady and colleagues (2021) studied **7,331 Twitter users and 12.7 million tweets**, plus two behavioral experiments with **240 participants**. Positive social feedback for outrage increased subsequent outrage expression; perceived network norms also mattered. [3]

Evidence boundary: this examines how feedback shapes later expression. It does not establish that our selected accounts were intentionally seeking engagement.

4. Attention and sharing can move in opposite directions

Dutceac Segesten and colleagues (2022; online 2020) exposed **96 participants to 20 Facebook news posts** with agreeing or disagreeing comment pairs. Disagreement increased attention to comments overall, reduced reported willingness to share, and did not change reported willingness to read overall. Effects also varied by news type. [4]

Evidence boundary: gaze was observed, but reading and sharing were self-reported intentions rather than actual platform actions.

Engagement is not endorsement.

Published effects help frame a hypothesis; our reply ratios do not test whether disagreement causes engagement.

Agreement and conflict can coexist

A group can agree enthusiastically with a post criticizing someone else. Political out-group findings [2] illustrate why agreement within a conversation need not mean positive or harmonious content. Our separate stance and evaluation measures preserve that distinction.

The reinforcement findings [3] offer a possible mechanism by which repeated feedback could shape posting behavior. Applying that mechanism to any sampled account would be an **untested interpretation**: we did not collect its history of rewards or experimentally vary them.

What a direct Threads test would need

Measure engagement after the classified message is posted, over a common observation window. Keep **subsequent replies, unique participants, likes and reposts** separate. Where available, use impressions to distinguish response propensity from simple differences in exposure.

Compare otherwise similar messages while accounting for topic, account audience, post age, prior popularity and conversation context. A matched or longitudinal analysis could estimate associations; a suitably designed randomized experiment would be needed for stronger causal attribution. Our present sample establishes neither an engagement advantage nor deliberate engagement-seeking.

References

- [1] Mochon, D., and Schwartz, J. (2024). The confrontation effect: When users engage more with ideology-inconsistent content online. *Organizational Behavior and Human Decision Processes*, 185, 104366. [doi:10.1016/j.obhdp.2024.104366](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.obhdp.2024.104366)
- [2] Rathje, S., Van Bavel, J. J., and van der Linden, S. (2021). Out-group animosity drives engagement on social media. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 118(26), e2024292118. [doi:10.1073/pnas.2024292118](https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2024292118)
- [3] Brady, W. J., McLoughlin, K., Doan, T. N., and Crockett, M. J. (2021). How social learning amplifies moral outrage expression in online social networks. *Science Advances*, 7(33), eabe5641. [doi:10.1126/sciadv.abe5641](https://doi.org/10.1126/sciadv.abe5641)
- [4] Dutceac Segesten, A., Bossetta, M., Holmberg, N., and Niehorster, D. C. (2022). The cueing power of comments on social media: How disagreement in Facebook comments affects user engagement with news. *Information, Communication & Society*, 25(8), 1115-1134. First published online 12 December 2020. [doi:10.1080/1369118X.2020.1850836](https://doi.org/10.1080/1369118X.2020.1850836)

Research sources checked 19 September 2026. These studies concern Facebook, Twitter or experimental settings, not a direct validation on Threads. Research authors are credited; sampled social-media account identities remain omitted.

Account labels replace identities.

Account 01 through Account 06 identify the same sampled accounts consistently across the report, data and charts.

Broad discussion category	Replies
Public affairs	7
Sports	29
Fashion and film	7
Food	13
Fitness	7
Technology and transport	1
Politics	31
Collecting and hobbies	9
Public transport and manners	44
Film interpretation	31
Productivity app	28
Leisure	20
Education and motivation	4
Creative quality	2

What the shared package contains

The package contains anonymous account summaries, 120 reply classifications, 26 authored-post classifications, 233 broad-cohort classifications, discussion totals, computed counts and the editable PDF builder. All numerical findings are unchanged.

Account handles, display names, profile links, post URLs, original post identifiers, contextual excerpts and the identity mapping are omitted from the shared package. The data use new neutral record labels.

These are de-identified research outputs. Detailed source rationales are omitted because they could help locate individuals. Earlier identified working records are outside this package. Anonymous labels do not guarantee that no one could infer identity from other information.

The source material was observed on Threads on 18-19 September 2026. Four overlapping replies were deduplicated for the 349-unique-reply inventory. Cohort-specific ratios remain separate; the earlier nine exploratory follow-ups are outside the reported totals.